CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · NCERT-TYPE UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Nathu, at the start of the story, is grumbling because: 1

(a) Sitaram insulted him **(b)** he has not been paid his regular salary
(c) he lost his broom **(d)** the bank refused him a loan

2. The extract is set in Germany during: 1

(a) the Cold War **(b)** World War I (1914-1918)
(c) World War II (1939-1945) **(d)** the French Revolution

3. Langston Hughes, the poet, is described in the book as: 1

(a) a French painter
(b) an American writer and activist known for jazz poetry
(c) a British novelist of fairy tales
(d) an Indian freedom fighter

4. The pale-faced man calls the sight under the microscope 'wonderful' mainly because: 1

(a) the Bacteriologist had made it himself
(b) the colours were pretty
(c) the slide was costly
(d) tiny streaks of pink could multiply and wreck a whole city

5. 'Bankrupt' as explained in the margin means: 1

(a) closed for repairs
(b) very rich
(c) without enough money to pay what has been borrowed
(d) famous

6. When Liesel told Papa about the party's checks, he praised her by saying: 1

(a) Smart girl **(b)** Quick runner **(c)** Brave boy **(d)** Silly child

7. What does the world receive from Keller's 'dower'? 1

(a) a map of the world
(b) a new language
(c) a gift of gold
(d) the message of the strength of inner power

8. The visitor says he has 'wasted an hour'. This helps him to: 1

(a) call the police **(b)** ask for a drink
(c) start a quarrel **(d)** leave politely with the tube

9. Some people boasted of their 'farsightedness'. This means they claimed to be: 1

(a) wise enough to see what would happen in the future
(b) angry
(c) rich
(d) lucky

10. The heading 'The longest three minutes in Hubermann history' stresses that: 1

(a) the inspection was boring **(b)** the match went on
(c) Papa had a long speech **(d)** time felt endless because of fear

11. The word 'receives' in 'the world receives' suggests the world is: 1

(a) fighting her **(b)** benefiting from her message
(c) ignoring her **(d)** robbing her

12. The Anarchist calls himself a 'Martyr' because he: 1

(a) believes he is dying for his cause **(b)** is a soldier
(c) is a doctor **(d)** has won a prize

13. Sitaram, who meets Nathu on the steps of the bank, earns his living as: 1

(a) a washerman's son delivering pressed clothes
(b) a barber's helper
(c) a shopkeeper
(d) a bank clerk

14. Liesel and her parents are secretly sheltering a Jewish man named: 1

(a) Max Vandenburg **(b)** Klaus Behrig **(c)** Hans Diller **(d)** Rudy Steiner

15. Hughes was a leader of the Harlem Renaissance, which means he helped in the revival of: 1

(a) Greek drama
(b) African-American literature, art, music and dance
(c) Indian classical music only
(d) medieval architecture

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why was Nathu annoyed at the beginning of the story? 2

17. What did Liesel hear at Frau Diller's shop that made her panic? 2

18. Who wrote the poem 'Helen Keller'? Mention one fact about him. 2

19. What is the 'Before You Read' picture and what are you asked to think about? 2

20. How did Jugal Kishore pass on the news? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Describe the opening scene of the story and what it tells us about Nathu. 3

22. Describe Liesel's quick thinking after learning of the party's checks. 3

23. What did Keller discover in the 'light' according to the poem, and does our eyesight decide whether we see such light? 3

24. Why does the Bacteriologist say they have to keep the living bacteria, though the slide on the table was dead? 3

OR

Describe the scene of the rumour spreading in the bazaar. 3

25. How did the family make the situation look ordinary when the party man came in? 3

OR

Why is the poet's use of one word, 'She', at the start of two stanzas effective? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Describe in order how the rumour about the bank spread from Nathu to the protest outside the bank. 5

OR

Write a character sketch of Liesel Hubermann on the basis of the extract. 5

27. Explain the poem 'Helen Keller' in your own words, stanza by stanza. 5

OR

Narrate the story 'The Stolen Bacillus' in your own words in 8-10 sentences. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND